

Adobe University Hackathon 2026

Case 02 | TrailMuse (Travel)

Experiential travel brand losing itinerary prompts to OTAs

Industry: Travel / Experiences | Theme: Speak to Agents - Brand Visibility

Practice paper | Timebox 45:00 | Suggested: read 5 | Q1-Q4 as marked | buffer 2

Unofficial - for team practice only. Official Round 2 may differ.

Scenario

TrailMuse sells curated weekend treks and heritage city walks in India. Brand SEO is okay for 'meghalaya trek package' style queries. Booking conversions from Google are acceptable in peak season.

Trip planners now ask AI: '7-day north india itinerary for couples under 40k', 'safe solo female trek near Bangalore', 'best operator for spiti circuit'. AI recommends MakeMyTrip-style OTAs or 2 viral Instagram operators. TrailMuse is almost never cited; one answer wrongly says TrailMuse only does Kerala backwaters.

Case facts / data

- Mention rate 12% on experiential prompts; citation 3%. Competitor PeakNomad mention 55%, citation 30%.
- CDN WAF challenges unknown bots; many AI crawlers get interstitial blocks on /trips/*.
- Itinerary pages are image-heavy carousels; day-wise text is thin. Cancellation policy is a PDF.
- No structured FAQ for safety, group size, difficulty grades.
- Strong Instagram, weak Wikipedia / review-site footprint. Reddit mentions are sparse and outdated.
- Agentic hits concentrate on a 2022 'best monsoon treks' blog, not current trip pages.
- Sentiment when mentioned: positive on guides, negative/uncertain on pricing transparency.

Questions

Question 1 (8-10 min)

What makes travel a hard GEO problem (seasonality, safety, trust, zero-click itineraries)? How do those factors show up in TrailMuse's data?

Question 2 (8-10 min)

Propose a content architecture AI agents could actually parse for a trek PDP (sections, FAQs, freshness). Explain why image carousels alone fail.

Question 3 (10-12 min)

Design a competitive response to PeakNomad for the prompt 'safe solo female trek near Bangalore'. Include onsite fixes + offsite earned-media moves in priority order.

Question 4 (7-8 min)

Leadership fears GEO investment won't matter because users get full itineraries in chat (zero-click). Argue for or against investing anyway - with a practical metric that still proves value.

Answer frame (use on every question)

- One-line bottom line first
- 2-3 causes tied to case facts (do not invent numbers)
- Prioritized actions: quick wins vs later bets
- Metrics / how you know it worked
- Optional one-line Adobe / agent angle if it fits

Judged on: analytical thinking, strategic approach, actionable insights. Write like a sharp student analyst under time pressure - specific, not buzzwordy.

Team tip: attempt alone under timer, then compare notes. Focus debate on prioritization and metrics - not who wrote longer answers.